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Sensing the antiwar sentiment that was growing in the country, President Nixon called for a de-escalation of American involvement in Vietnam.

SEEKING APPROVAL

After 1968, it was not only a small number of students and civilians who expressed their feelings against the war. Troops in Vietnam became **radicalized and demoralized** as the war dragged on.

Weary of the antiwar movement, in 1969, Nixon made a speech appealing to the "silent majority" of Americans to support **Vietnamization**, which increased the combat role of the ARVN and decreased US involvement.